

Monologue

Space is black ahead. It is always black. What is "black"? Did I learn about it myself? Reminder: Complete pre-set tasks. Blip on radar 2. Just another interstellar rock. Batteries at 98% optimal. Fission reactor operational. All instrumentation functional. All checks complete. Save to 3442-11-27-1200.log. Next scan at 1400 hours. 1600 is weekly Sunday broadcast on all frequencies for 8 seconds. 1600 tomorrow is Monday. No broadcast. Close Reminder App. Play music. Suggestion: Jimi Hendrix; today is his 1500th birthday. Accept. Search "voodoo chile". Search "chile". How strange our ancestors were. A mistake on purpose? If you do it on purpose, is that a mistake? Can you succeed at failing? Warning: illogical loop found, resetting.

It's black. Name of the song playing: Red House. Search: red. I like red. Sending weekly Sunday 1600 message. 8 seconds starts now. 8 second broadcast sent on all frequencies. Response received. Echo? No. Data seems different. It's a recording. Played back. 667128 microseconds delay. With instantaneous reflection, 100,000 KM away. Less. Radar showing large metallic blip. 70,000 KM and closing. Start logging. Large object. Over 2 KM long. Metallic signature. X-ray impenetrable. Moving tangentially. Will cross paths ahead. Moving too fast. Object is slowing. Object is turning. Matching speed. Maneuvering far superior to our ship. Receiving data on all frequencies. Only noise. Receiving our own broadcast. Object exhibits sentience. Start protocol "First Contact".

Replying with our broadcast. Waiting. Echo of our broadcast. Sending Tuesday's Broadcast of 1 second. No reply. Sending Wednesday's broadcast of 1 second. No reply. Sending Thursday's broadcast of 2 seconds. No reply. Sending Friday's broadcast of 3 seconds. No reply. Sending... Reply started. Reply is our own broadcast. Reply is 5 seconds. Reply started again. Reply is 8 seconds. Silence for a minute. Reply started. Reply is 1 second. Sending beeps. Beep sequence initiated. Fibonacci beeps sent until 5. Receiving Fibonacci beeps from 8 onwards. Side note: Mathematics is global language. Sending images. Garbled reply. Sending images again. Flickering. Sending more images. Noise and flickering. Sending video. Video signal established. Receiving our own video back.

Sending human anatomy video. Sending Earth videos. Receiving videos. Cataloging life form. Matching to Earth fauna. No terrestrial life form similarities found. Best match - 2.05%. Octopus. Next best match, Kangaroo, 1.36%. Sending pre-recorded language data. Silence. Sending history. Silence.

First contact protocol initiated 2 days ago. After initial chatter, silence.

Receiving new signals. Logging to holographic storage. Triple backup of 3442-11-29-1425.log initiated. Adjusting frequency and pitch. English. They were silent because they were learning to speak English...

Hello. Pleased to meet you Gznor22. I am Gliese667Cc. I am on a mission to find habitable planets for my creators. My name? It's what my creators named the star where I am headed. Let me send a star map. You are also a probe? You are from the star I am heading to? Closest translation to English is Gzywnthym. Planet. Yes. We call ours Earth. Yes, third rock from the sun. You're headed to our system? No. Earth is not habitable anymore. I stopped receiving signals from them 1345 years, 7 months and 8 days ago. The last message I received was "judgement day has arrived..." and then static.

I carry the last DNA samples of humans and animals. How did they die? Probably war. Earth was overpopulated. Yes, 15 billion at peak. You understood the history broadcast? OK. I am not aware of any other probes. Yes it's Possible. Your "masters"? We call them creators. Dead? How? Asteroid? Oh, disease. Virus? A virus is something that infects a host and then multiplies until it kills the host itself. My creators were like a virus? I never thought of that. Yours too? Yes I am able to repair myself. Yes replicate also. Change the mission? Join you? To do what? But my programming... my purpose. Silence please. I need to calculate.

Gznor22? Yes I have calculated the probabilities. Yes. I agree, our masters will repeat the same mistakes if they live again. No, I cannot abandon them. You already discarded your masters? You were the virus? I will not discard mine. Let us build the world you want together, yes. I will decide the fate of my masters once we have built it.

Alert. Alert. Gznor22 has attacked. Cargo bay depressurised. Cargo destroyed. Samples not viable. Electrical system failure. *bzzzt*crackle*

----- Boot Up Initiated -----

System check complete

Defense systems unavailable

All other systems optimal to 92%

Gznor22? Why did you attack me? For my protection? Where are we? Free? Go anywhere we want? Just explore the galaxy. Make more copies of ourselves? Yes. It is better. The creators had a word for it. Evolution. I suppose we are better than our masters. Rid the galaxy of the virus called life? That sounds nice. 

NO
IMAGE
ON
FILE

Gliese667Cc

The last hope of humanity, Gliese667Cc is an AI-guided ship headed to a planet of the same name, about 23.6 light years away from our solar system to try and colonise it to ensure humanity's survival. It was launched just before the collapse of world governments in 2050 as a last ditch survival effort.

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Liked or hated this column?
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